
DOMINIONS 6 NATION DOSSIER

Middle Age Ashdod

Reign of the Anakim

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Unmodded 6.36 doctrine with source-labelled rules, strategy, and open verification work.

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Middle Age Ashdod: Reign of the Anakim

Ashdod one-page command brief

Middle Age Ashdod combines human slaves and nine recruitable giant troop profiles with a compact mage corps built around Fire, Earth, Astral, Death, and Holy magic. Five commanders and seven troops are available from ordinary forts. The capital adds three expensive mage-commanders, two sacred Anakites, and two sites producing five gems each month.

The reliable structure is:

- cheap human Slingers and Slaves can fill low-cost roles while Edomites and the larger Rephaite troops supply the national giant line;
- Amorites, Gileadites, Gileadite Archers, and Bashanites trade gold, resources, armour, shields, weapons, and recruitment points rather than forming one interchangeable elite class;
- Sheshai and Ahiman Anakites are capital-only sacreds with distinct armour and combat profiles;
- ordinary forts can recruit Kohanim, Emites, and Rephaite Sages, while the capital queue must divide four-point turns among Adons, Zamzummites, and Talmai Elders;
- the capital produces F1 E2 S1 D1, with no native Air, Water, Nature, Glamour, or Blood income;
- recruitable randoms can reach deep Fire, Earth, Astral, and Death, but several important cross-path combinations are rare;
- national Conjuration includes angels, ancestor spirits, and Mazzikim, while Strange Fire supplies one national battlefield spell;
- Ashdod has no national item or rebate record in the pinned item table.

Ashdod's planning problem is concentration. Its strongest bodies and deepest mages are expensive, resource-heavy, capital-bound, or random-dependent. A plan that buys only premium giants can lose infrastructure and mage tempo, while a plan that treats random paths as guaranteed can reach research with no legal caster.

Ashdod evidence and ruleset

This chapter covers unmodded MA Ashdod on the Book I 6.36 live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls the player-facing roster, explicit capital restrictions, printed paths, national summary, site income, national spell tables, and ritual requirements. Identifiers, recruitment membership, random masks, site fields, hero records, and nation restrictions are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

No Ashdod, Anakite, Rephaite, Zamzummite, Ditanu, Malik, or named Ashdod national-spell match appears in the collected official patch ledger through 6.36. No named patch correction is therefore applied. A negative ledger search does not establish undocumented engine behaviour.

Ashdod conversion chain

cheap human bodies, giant infantry, and five capital gems
 -> a target-specific line backed by ordinary-fort researchers
 -> protected capital recruitment and recorded random paths
 -> separate Fire, Earth, Astral, and Death treasuries
 -> battlefield support, sacred reserves, angels, or ancestor summons
 -> surviving armies, sieges, Throne claims, and replacement cycles

The chain breaks when human slaves are mistaken for durable giants, when every giant profile is priced as if resources were unlimited, when a Talmi path is budgeted before recruitment, or when a national ritual is counted without both its caster and gem type.

Ashdod national rules that shape the plan

Rule or asset	Operational consequence
Rephaite giants	Most national troops have high Hit Points and Strength, but their gold, resources, recruitment points, appetite, size, and formation needs remain real costs.
Human slaves	Seven-gold Slingers and Spearmen provide a separate low-cost body class; low Morale and ordinary human durability limit what that price buys.
Prefers Heat +2	The nation summary identifies the preferred climate; this is not a complete scales recommendation.
Heat limit +1 and Death limit +1	Pretender design can select those scales one step beyond the ordinary limit. The strategic value depends on the whole design and map.
Giant Forts	Ashdod uses the printed giant-fort family rather than a standard-fort label. Local construction value and timing still depend on province and campaign.
Weak priesthood with one medium priest	Kohanim and Zamzummmites are H1; capital Adons reach H2. Priest access exists, but high-priest work competes for the capital queue.
Sacred Anakites and capital mage-commanders	The strongest sacred troops and all three deep mage chassis are capital-only, making capital turns a strategic resource.

Ashdod capital sites and recruitment geography

Site	Verified fields	Recruitment or income consequence
The Twin Cities, site 144	D1; home recruitment for Sheshai Anakite, Ahiman Anakite, Zamzummite, Adon, and Talmi Elder	Holds the full capital-only troop and commander set
Mount Seir, site 145	F1 E2 S1	Completes the capital's Fire, Earth, Astral, and Death income

The capital produces five gems per month: F1 E2 S1 D1. It produces no Air, Water, Nature, Glamour, or Blood gems. Caster access and gem income must therefore be recorded separately, especially for Summon Mazzikim and Call Arel, which require Nature.

Complete Ashdod commander membership

ID	Commander	Gold	Resources	Rec points	Verified recruitment
2010	Edomite Scout	45	17	1	Forts
2009	Rephaite Commander	140	35	1	Forts
2029	Kohen	120	3	1	Forts
2038	Emite	175	3	2	Forts
2060	Rephaite Sage	215	3	2	Forts
2027	Adon	425	85	4	Capital only
2011	Zamzummite	440	3	4	Capital only
2028	Talmai Elder	520	3	4	Capital only

The five ordinary and three capital records reconcile to eight distinct commanders. The capital entries are additional home-site recruits, not ordinary-fort duplicates.

Complete Ashdod troop membership

ID	Troop	Gold	Resources	Rec points	Verified recruitment
2003	Human Slinger	7	2	3	Forts
2004	Human Slave	7	3	3	Forts
2005	Edomite	20	15	15	Forts
2006	Amorite	40	27	17	Forts
2007	Gileadite	40	29	17	Forts
2061	Gileadite Archer	40	47	17	Forts
2008	Bashanite	50	33	21	Forts
2025	Sheshai Anakite	130	50	47	Capital only
2026	Ahiman Anakite	130	89	47	Capital only

The seven ordinary and two capital records reconcile to nine distinct troops. The two Anakites share price and recruitment-point cost but do not share the same armour, protection, Morale, Strength, Attack, Defence, or Fire Resistance.

Complete Ashdod roster by job

Unit or group	Best source-backed role	Important limit
Human Slinger	Cheapest national missile body	Low Morale, light protection, and sling performance depend on range and target.
Human Slave	Cheapest spear frontage	Low Morale and ordinary human durability make it a screen rather than a giant substitute.
Edomite	Lower-cost javelin and spear giant	Less durable and less skilled than the larger Rephaim.
Amorite	Mobile poison-tipped spear giant	Moderate armour and lack of shield change its survival profile.
Gileadite	Shielded spear giant	Resources and encumbrance exceed the Edomite line.

Unit or group	Best source-backed role	Important limit
Gileadite Archer	Armoured great-bow giant	Forty-seven resources and low Defence make protection and positioning important.
Bashanite	Strong broad-sword line giant	Fifty gold and 21 recruitment points constrain mass replacement.
Sheshai Anakite	Capital sacred attacker with Berserker +2 and Fire Resistance +10	Capital-only, 130 gold, and 50 resources.
Ahiman Anakite	Heavier capital sacred with higher Protection, Morale, Strength, Attack, and Defence	Eighty-nine resources and the same capital-only queue.

Ashdod commander and mage portfolio

Commander	Paths or ability	Main jobs	Recruitment warning
Edomite Scout	Stealth 50; forest, mountain, and waste survival	Intelligence and route checking	Seventeen resources compete with troops.
Rephaite Commander	Leadership 100	Giant army command	Thirty-five resources and 140 gold are paid for a non-mage leader.
Kohen	H1; pinned independent 10% Death level	Low priest and occasional Death access	The manual prints H1 only; the 10% field remains pinned, not live-confirmed.
Emite	D1 plus guaranteed F/E/S/D level; Fortune Teller 10	Death research, event support, and low random magic	Final path must be recorded before assignment.
Rephaite Sage	One guaranteed level two in F/E/S; Research +4	Efficient research and a focused level-two path	No fixed path exists before the random resolves.
Adon	H2 plus one guaranteed level two in F/E/S; Leadership 150; sacred; Research -4	Capital army-priest and deep elemental or Astral support	425 gold, 85 resources, four recruitment points, and a research penalty.
Zamzummite	E1 D2 H1 plus E/D and F/E/S/D randoms; Spirit Sight	Deep Death, ancestor rituals, undead leadership, and mixed magic	Capital-only, 440 gold, and four recruitment points.
Talmai Elder	One guaranteed level three in F/E/S plus pinned 10% F/E/S/D level; Research +8; Forge Bonus 1	Deep research, forging, and rare cross-path access	Capital-only, 520 gold, four recruitment points, and the second slot is not printed by the manual.

Reading the ordinary Ashdod randoms

Mage	Fixed paths	Pinned random scheme	Result
Kohen	H1	Independent 10% D1	D1 on 10%; no Death level on 90%
Emite	D1	One guaranteed F/E/S/D level	25% each; a Death result reaches D2
Rephaite Sage	None	One guaranteed level two in F/E/S	F2, E2, or S2 at one third each
Adon	H2	One guaranteed level two in F/E/S	F2, E2, or S2 at one third each

These are recruitment probabilities, not delivery dates. Gold, recruitment points, fort location, survival, and the order of results decide when the path can be used.

Reading the Zamzummite random paths

The Zamzummite has fixed E1 D2 H1. Its first guaranteed random is E or D, and its second guaranteed random is F, E, S, or D.

Portfolio result	Probability per Zamzummite
Fire 1	25%
Astral 1	25%
At least one extra Earth level	62.5%
Both randoms Earth, reaching E3	12.5%
At least one extra Death level, reaching at least D3	62.5%
Both randoms Death, reaching D4	12.5%

Fixed E1 D2 means every Zamzummite already has both Earth and Death. The table describes how the two randoms deepen or broaden that base; it does not establish a recruitment timetable.

Reading the Talmai Elder random paths

The Talmai Elder has one guaranteed level-three result in Fire, Earth, or Astral. The pinned record also contains an independent 10% one-level result from Fire, Earth, Astral, or Death, while the manual prints only ?3.

Portfolio result	Probability per Talmai Elder
Primary F3, E3, or S3	One third each
No secondary level	90%
Named F, E, S, or D secondary	2.5% each
A chosen F, E, or S path appears at least once	35%
Matching primary and secondary, reaching level four	About 0.833% for that named path
Death 1	2.5%

A Talmai can satisfy S2 F1 for Strange Fire when the primary and secondary rolls split between Astral and Fire. That combined result occurs in two orientations, about 1.667% in total. Call Hashmal specifically needs S3 F1, which occurs only when the primary is Astral and the secondary is Fire, about 0.833%.

Ashdod native path boundary

Path	Repeatable access	Boundary
Fire	Emite F1 random; Rephaite Sage or Adon F2 random; Talmai F3 primary with rare F4	No fixed Fire recruit, and Fire-Astral cross-paths depend on rare Talmai results.
Earth	Fixed E1 Zamzummite; random E2 Sages and Adons; E3 Talmai; Zamzummite can reach E3	Broad access, but the deepest results remain random or capital-bound.
Astral	Random S1 Emite or Zamzummite; random S2 Sage or Adon; S3 Talmai with rare S4	No recruitable result reaches S5 unaided.

Path	Repeatable access	Boundary
Death	Fixed D1 Emite and D2 Zamzummite; randoms can reach D2, D3, or D4	Zamzummite supports the national ancestor rituals, subject to its random result.
Holy	H1 Kohen and Zamzummite; H2 Adon	Medium priesthood is capital-only.
Air, Water, Nature, Glamour, Blood	No recruitable mage	Require independents, a Pretender, empowerment, summons, heroes, or another proved bridge.

The three national heroes add deep Fire, Earth, Water, Astral, and Holy paths, but heroes are not repeatable recruitment and are not assumed to arrive on schedule.

Ashdod national spell and ritual reconciliation

ID	Spell or ritual	School	Requirement	Cost	Printed result
345	Strange Fire	Evocation 4	S2 F1	20 fatigue	Area 3, armour-piercing, 8+ damage
358	Summon Mazzikim	Conjuration 3	N1	3 Nature gems	10 Mazzikim
352	Call Malakh	Conjuration 4	S2	9 Astral pearls	1 Malakh
353	Call Hashmal	Conjuration 6	S3 F1	21 Astral pearls	1 Hashmal
347	Dirge for the Dead	Conjuration 6	D3 H1	25 Death gems	1 Ditanu
354	Call Arel	Conjuration 7	S4 N1	39 Astral pearls	1 Arel
355	Call Ophan	Conjuration 8	S5 F2	49 Astral pearls	1 Ophan
348	Banquet for the Dead	Conjuration 8	D4 H1	55 Death gems	1 Malik and 4 Ditanu
356	Call Merkavah	Conjuration 9	S7 F3	222 Astral pearls	1 Chayot

The nine structured rows restrict to nation 64, alone or with the other named nations shown in the official tables. Printed summon counts and requirements are retained without inferring retinue behaviour, shape mechanics, or battlefield performance.

Ashdod ritual access from repeatable mages

Call Malakh is directly available to an S2 Rephaite Sage or Adon and to an S3 Talmai, each a one-third result on its chassis. Strange Fire needs S2 F1 on one caster; only the rare split Talmai secondary produces the necessary recruitable combination. Call Hashmal needs the narrower S3 F1 Talmai result.

A Zamzummite reaches D3 H1 whenever at least one random adds Death, a 62.5% result, qualifying for Dirge for the Dead. It reaches D4 H1 only when both randoms add Death, a 12.5% result, qualifying for Banquet for the Dead.

Summon Mazzikim and Call Arel need Nature, which no recruitable mage has. No recruit reaches the S5 F2 threshold for Call Ophan or S7 F3 for Call Merkavah. Boosters, empowerment, summons,

heroes, or a Pretender can change access, but each bridge must be named and funded before the ritual is counted.

Ashdod capital and ritual gem economy

The capital's F1 E2 S1 D1 income naturally supports Earth work and slowly accumulates the Astral and Death currencies used by most national summons. It does not produce Nature gems for Mazzikim or Arel. A Nature caster and a Nature treasury are separate missing parts.

The highest angelic rituals cost 49 or 222 Astral pearls, while the ancestor rituals cost 25 or 55 Death gems. Research, caster rarity, gem accumulation, forging, and battlefield use compete for different bottlenecks. A legal path does not prove that the ritual is timely or affordable.

Ashdod national item boundary

No item in the pinned BaseI.csv carries Ashdod's nation ID 64 in the national-restriction or national-rebate fields. The dossier therefore records no Ashdod national item, national discount, or national forging exception.

This is a structured-snapshot result, not a claim that ordinary magic items are unavailable. General forging follows Book V and the current game interface; final displayed costs and any undocumented exception remain outside this source-only statement.

Ashdod national hero records

ID	Fixed name	Unit name	Verified magic or status
2047	Sheshai	First Son of Anak	F4 H2; sacred; pinned late-hero field 20
2048	Ahiman	Second Son of Anak	E4 H2; sacred; pinned late-hero field 20
2049	Talmai	Third Son of Anak	F1 W4 E1 S4 H2; sacred; pinned late-hero field 20

The hero records provide powerful but non-repeatable access, including the nation's only listed Water path. No arrival probability, arrival turn, guaranteed ritual bridge, or meaning of the raw late-hero value is inferred.

Ashdod patch reconciliation

No direct Ashdod, Anakite, Rephaite, Zamzummite, Talmai Elder, Malakh, Hashmal, Arel, Ophan, Merkavah, Ditanu, Malik, or Mazzikim name match was found in the official ledger through 6.36. No patch change is attached to the roster or national spell tables.

This is a narrow search result. It does not prove that every current engine interaction matches the pinned snapshot, and it does not turn undocumented behaviour into a fact.

Ashdod opening priorities

The opening should separate three budgets: enough bodies to take and hold territory, enough infrastructure to recruit research mages outside the capital, and enough protection for the home queue to produce its rare deep casters. Human troops cost seven gold, but their Morale and durability differ sharply from the giant line. Exact expansion counts remain open because opposition, scales, formation, bless, terrain, and combat rolls change them.

The ordinary mage choices solve different problems. Emitees guarantee D1 and a broad level-one random; Sages provide Research +4 and one focused level-two path. Rephaite Commanders keep leadership off the mage queue, but their gold and resources must be justified against the troops they lead.

Ashdod recruitment packages to evaluate from reports

Human screen and giant damage line

Human Slaves or Slingers can provide cheap bodies while Amorites, Gileadites, or Bashanites supply giant damage. The package should be chosen against the reported weapons and protection. Low-Morale humans can fail before the premium line does, and large units still need enough frontage.

Shielded Gileadite line

Gileadites bring shields, spears, Morale 13, and Protection 14. They cost forty gold, 29 resources, and 17 recruitment points. The package is useful when missile and contact protection matter, but it should not be purchased by habit when the enemy calls for poison spears, swords, missiles, or cheaper bodies.

Giant missile group

Gileadite Archers carry great bows behind Protection 17. Their forty-seven-resource cost can sharply reduce output in a weak fort. Target armour, shields, weather, range, and positioning remain battle questions, so recruitment should respond to reports rather than a universal ratio.

Capital Anakite reserve

Sheshai and Ahiman Anakites are sacred capital troops with different offensive and defensive profiles. Sheshai is cheaper in resources and has Berserker +2 and Fire Resistance +10; Ahiman spends 89 resources for heavier protection and better core combat statistics. Bless value and survival remain matchup-dependent.

Ashdod research response tree

Branch A: ordinary Earth, Fire, and Astral support

Rephaite Sages and Adons produce F2, E2, or S2 in equal thirds. Early research should answer a named protection, damage, fatigue, or resistance problem rather than chase a path label. The result must be recorded before a spell package is assigned.

Branch B: national Conjunction

Conjunction 4 opens Call Malakh for S2 results. Conjunction 6 adds Hashmal for a rare Talmai and Dirge for a qualifying Zamzummite. Later levels offer Arel, Ophan, Banquet for the Dead, and Merkavah, but each has a distinct path and treasury gate. National availability does not make every ritual natively castable.

Branch C: Strange Fire

Evocation 4 unlocks Strange Fire, an S2 F1 armour-piercing area spell. The repeatable recruitable combination is rare because it depends on a split Talmai primary and secondary result. Researching the spell before such a caster exists creates no battlefield package.

Branch D: Death and ancestor economy

Every Zamzummite begins at D2 H1 and has a 62.5% chance to reach at least D3, while 12.5% reach D4. This branch can plan around Dirge and Banquet, but capital turns, 25- or 55-gem costs, undead leadership, summoned composition, and delivery must all be budgeted.

Ashdod battlefield packages

Giant line with mundane command

A Rephaite Commander leads the selected giant line while a Sage, Emite, or Zamzummite handles magic. Separating leadership preserves mage actions, but the commander itself costs 140 gold and 35 resources. The force still needs answers to fatigue, armour, flanks, and magic that bypasses mundane protection.

Mixed human and Rephaite force

Cheap humans expand frontage or absorb low-value contact while the giants supply damage. Morale and speed differences can split the formation or routing sequence. The package should be judged from battle reports rather than assumed to behave as one uniform line.

Capital sacred force

Anakites form an expensive sacred reserve with an H2 Adon available from the same capital. This compresses troops, priesthood, and deep random magic into one queue. The force must justify both the capital turns and the resources that could have produced many ordinary giants.

Ancestor-supported force

Dirge or Banquet adds Ditanu and Malik records to a national army. Their printed paths, ethereal and undead status, Fear, leadership, and weapon profiles are source facts. Their retinue organisation, replacement, spell use, and battlefield outcomes remain unresolved until observed.

Ashdod Pretender families

Family	What it solves	What it must not conceal
Economy and infrastructure	Funds giant forts, laboratories, premium troops, and capital mages	Income does not add capital recruitment points or local resources.
Nature bridge	Opens Mazzikim and helps reach Arel while adding a missing gem path	A path without Nature income, research, and mage-turns remains incomplete.
Astral-Fire bridge	Makes Strange Fire and angel thresholds deliberate rather than rare Talmai outcomes	High Astral ritual costs still need a treasury and delivery plan.
Death support	Accelerates ancestor rituals and Death searching	Zamzummites already offer deep random Death; duplication should solve a timing problem.
Sacred design	Supports Anakites, Adons, Zamzummites, and sacred summons	Most ordinary troops and human slaves are not blessed.
Awake expander	Supplies early independent-taking power while expensive queues develop	Afflictions, counters, and delayed scales can erase the gain.

Ashdod matchup and failure matrix

Enemy problem	First answer to examine	Avoid
Massed light infantry	Giant Strength, protected lines, missiles, and area magic	Paying capital prices for work ordinary giants can perform.
Heavy armour	High Strength, poison weapons, Earth or Fire support, fatigue, and armour-answering magic	Assuming every spear or great bow solves every protection level.
Armour-piercing or armour-negating attacks	Spacing, resistance, disruption, summons, and cheaper screens	Treating large Hit Point totals as universal defence.
High Defence, ethereal, or Glamour targets	Area effects, magic weapons, attack support, Spirit Sight, and control	Assuming size and Strength answer unrelated defensive mechanics.
High Magic Resistance or mindless units	Physical pressure, buffs, summons, and non-MR effects	Building the fight around one Astral resistance check.
Fast flankers and flyers	Guards, reserves, dispersed mages, and protected routes	Leaving 440- or 520-gold capital mages exposed in one rear cluster.
Raids and dispersed pressure	Scouts, local forts, cheap replacement bodies, and reserve commanders	Concentrating every useful unit and mage in the capital.

Monthly Ashdod audit

- Is each fort limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns?
- Does the troop mix answer the reported weapons, armour, numbers, and terrain?
- Are human units performing a defined cheap role rather than being mistaken for giants?
- Is a mundane commander available where using a mage as leader would lose research or ritual tempo?
- Has every random mage been labelled by final paths before receiving a task?
- Are Fire, Earth, Astral, Death, and missing Nature treasuries tracked separately?
- Does each national ritual have a legal caster, research level, gem budget, commander, and delivery route?
- Are capital turns being divided deliberately among Adons, Zamzummites, Talmai Elders, and sacred troops?
- Is the plan paying for premium Anakites only when their distinct profile matters?
- Are hero paths excluded from any schedule that must be repeatable?

Ashdod unresolved evidence boundary

The following claims remain open:

- 1 exact expansion-party ranges for human screens, each Rephaite line, giant missiles, and Anakites;
- 2 live 6.36 confirmation of the Kohen and Talmai secondary random fields that the manual does not display;
- 3 Strange Fire targeting, friendly-fire risk, scaling, and battlefield results;
- 4 Ditanu, Malik, Malakh, Hashmal, Arel, Ophan, and Chayot scripting, retinue, shape, and combat behaviour;
- 5 final effective research and forge value of particular random mages under real scales and sites;
- 6 giant appetite, supply, movement, formation, siege, retreat, and replacement outcomes on a generated map;
- 7 hero arrival timing and the meaning of pinned late-hero values;
- 8 specific Pretender designs, scripts, blessings, and matchup performance.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. No runtime test or new test asset was prepared during this unit. R-047, R-058, and the wider hands-on testing queue remain parked until testing is explicitly resumed.

Dossier source register

Official

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: MA Ashdod nation pages; national spells and rituals; research; sacreds; forging; and fort construction.
- Illwinter official patch history through 6.36. No direct Ashdod, Anakite, Rephaite, Zamzummite, or named Ashdod national-spell match was found; no change was inferred from a negative ledger result.

Structured snapshot

- Dominions 6 Data Inspector, commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`, pinned to the 6.35 data update; used for mage random masks, recruitment records, capital sites, national spell restrictions, national item fields, and current object cross-checks.

Interpretation boundary

Roster entries, path masks, costs, site income, item restrictions, and national ritual requirements are source facts. Openings, research trees, Pretender families, battlefield packages, and matchup advice are strategy. Expansion counts, random-result timing, Blood returns, crossbreeding outputs, displayed forge-cost stacking, communion and Grand Communion outcomes, hydra-field behaviour, Spell Singer outcomes, Glamour detection, special-dominion scaling and targeting, ancestor-summon behaviour, spell targeting, and combat outcomes remain observation questions until a versioned raw set is published.